

“In total, we run 15 programmes every year. Every programme has an upper limit of 20 participants, meaning we churn out about 300 high quality start-ups every year”



ANISH ANTHONY, CHIEF DELIVERY OFFICER, T-HUB

about 600-700 corporate innovation programmes in partnerships with firms such as Amazon, Qualcomm, Hindustan Aeronautics, etc.

“For corporates which are focussed on innovation, but don’t know how to get there quickly, we want to bring open innovation to them. We work with them and design innovation approaches that they may not be familiar with,” says Sujit Jagirdar, Chief Innovation Officer of T-Hub. “We are creating sector-focussed themes to drive innovation, and also helping them build internal muscle to enable transformation within.” In addition, several corporates, including Cyient, Tech Mahindra, and Suzuki Motor have taken dedicated seats there to foster swift and effective connections with T-Hub’s start-ups.

Not only that, the incubator also serves as a hub for Consulate General-level foreign delegation visits that are aimed at facilitating market access and knowledge sharing for its start-ups. Anthony says T-Hub hosts an international government delegation every three days. For instance, recently Consul Generals from the US, Turkey and Sweden visited the facility in the same week. Even the Indo French Chamber of Commerce and Industry has taken up space in T-Hub and the French Consulate has shown interest in setting up an office there.

Such collaborations not only lend credence to the viability of a model like T-Hub, but also help the

start-ups land their first few clients. For instance, Sunil Maddikatla, CEO and Founder of healthtech start-up BlueSemi, says he received his first international order even before launching international sales, from a visiting German parliamentarian. “I received a call from MSR one fine morning asking me to present my idea to a group of German delegates. I did a live demo of my product and one of them loved it, and asked if I can send a few, so he can show it to his colleagues there,” he says. Maddikatla is now in the process of shipping 25 units of his non-invasive blood-glucose level measuring devices to Germany.

Meanwhile T-Hub’s partnerships with academia is aimed at fostering a problem-solving and innovation-oriented mindset among college students. It helps build incubation centres in academic institutions and trains their faculty to be incubation managers. Since the launch of the programme in November 2022, it has successfully launched three such projects, with three more in the pipeline.

T-Hub also runs accelerator programmes for various government bodies, such as the Ministry of Defence and the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology. It also manages the accelerator programmes of the state governments of Bihar, Odisha, Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh, and Goa, as well as for foreign governments like Kazakhstan, Bangladesh and the Maldives.

TAKING TO THE SKIES

“T-Hub has played a pivotal role in attracting investments to the state. Its reputation... [has] led to a substantial inflow of funds into Telangana’s start-up ecosystem,” says K.T. Rama Rao, Minister for IT for the Government of Telangana. “T-Hub has evolved into a remarkable centre of innovation that contributes significantly to employment and economic growth in Telangana.”

MSR says, T-Hub has played a central role in creating a friendly environment for start-ups. He says the goal is to grow their number to 20,000 within the next five years, and generate around 100,000 jobs.

B.V.R. Mohan Reddy, Founder Chairman and Board Member of Cyient Ltd, and a Founding Director of T-Hub, says the organisation will continuously adapt to the evolving needs of start-ups. “As the start-up landscape evolves, T-Hub will continue to be a driving force, empowering the next generation of entrepreneurs and contribute to India’s vision of becoming a global leader in innovation.”

Needless to say, T-Hub’s pioneering approach and state-of-the-art infrastructure have set a new benchmark for start-up ecosystems, making it a formidable contender to surpass other Indian cities and emerge as the premier destination for entrepreneurs to incubate their ideas into viable businesses. **BT**

@binu_t_paul